



Going forward:

Managing the continuing
professional development
of ESOL teachers in the UK



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esol.britishcouncil.org

INTRODUCTION

This handbook provides guidance for those managing ESOL (English for Speakers of Other Languages) teachers in different contexts throughout the UK. The term 'teacher'¹ includes those working, for example, as volunteers, teachers, lecturers, tutors, trainers and co-ordinators in publicly-funded adult ESOL provision (including 14–19 provision). ESOL teachers, as with other teachers in the learning and skills sector, are often referred to as 'dual professionals': they are both 'subject specialists' (ESOL) and professional teachers. Job titles may vary but ESOL practitioners work with a wide range of learners with English language needs and in a variety of settings, for example, in colleges, in work-based learning providers, in adult and community learning, in the MOD/armed services, in prisons and probation centres, in voluntary organisations and in the workplace.

ESOL learners have come to live in the UK for a variety of reasons; they may, for example, be asylum seekers, refugees, migrant workers, members of settled minority ethnic communities and their dependents, spouses or partners of British citizens.

Each of the four nations of the UK has its own inspectorate which regulates and inspects publicly-funded learning and skills provision, including ESOL. In an inspection, inspectors regularly evaluate the quality of provision and require details of qualifications and CPD activities carried out by staff. For information about the four inspectorates, go to

England:	www.ofsted.gov.uk
Scotland:	www.hmie.gov.uk
Wales:	www.estyn.gov.uk
Northern Ireland:	www.etini.gov.uk

This handbook provides information and guidance on promoting a culture and system of continuing professional development for ESOL subject specialist teachers in your department/organisation. It uses a framework that helps to identify the stage of career development a teacher is currently at and to plan training and activities relevant to their needs at that stage.

Creating an ethos which values and encourages professional development will help teachers meet the challenges of their work and achieve their own and their organisation's goals. The information in this handbook is based on the principle that the effective teacher is the developing teacher. It incorporates the idea of 'reflective practice' – the importance of reflecting on what you are doing – as an essential part of the development process.

There is a companion handbook for teachers. Information for teachers and managers is also available on the British Council's ESOL NEXUS CPD portal <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/teacher-development>

**This handbook was put together by:
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based on an original document by Tim Phillips**

1. The term 'teacher' is used to refer to anyone who is responsible for planning and carrying out teaching or learning delivery with a learner or learners – regardless of the number of hours they work, their job title or work context.

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WHY CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT?

It helps teachers stay motivated and positive about their work.

It benefits the learners as well as the teachers so it's good for our organisation.

Teachers value the opportunity to discuss their career and CPD options with me, and I try to point them in the right direction.

I believe that supporting teachers to undertake action research projects helps them to develop their professionalism and autonomy.

I can see that the teachers who are most active in their own professional development are also the ones who are most effective in meeting their learners' needs.

We have full-time, part-time and hourly-paid teachers. I find that having a lively culture of CPD among the staff promotes peer learning and provides a supportive working environment.

WHAT IS CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (CPD)?

‘Continuing professional development (CPD) is the process which ensures that all educational staff can, at all stages of their careers, develop their knowledge, improve their skills and enhance their confidence and motivation to affect ... learning positively.’

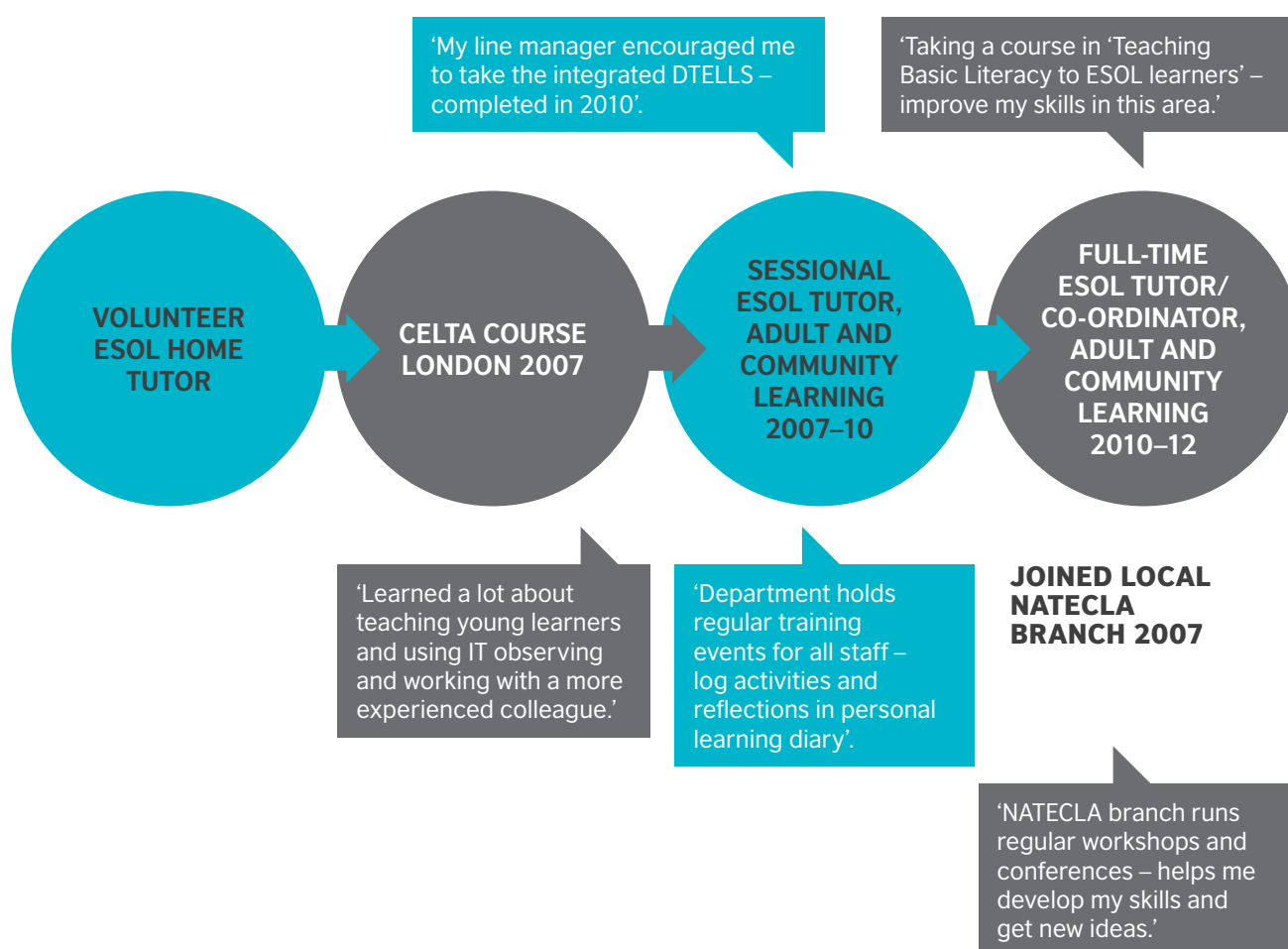
www.cpdscotland.org.uk/about/aboutcpd/index.asp

Key characteristics are that it is:

- continuous – professionals should always be looking for ways to deal with new challenges and improve performance
- personalised – the individual identifies his/her own needs and how to meet those needs
- critically reflected upon – the individual demonstrates that learning experiences and activities are meaningful, effective and improve practice
- formal (e.g. attending conferences or workshops) and informal (e.g. reading journal articles or reviewing websites)
- an integral part of professional life.

Here is an example of how one teacher, Anna, has managed some of her CPD in her first few years of teaching. It shows the different jobs she’s had as an ESOL teacher, some of the CPD activity she’s done at different stages of her career, and some of her notes on how she benefited from her CPD activity:

REGULAR PROGRAMME OF CPD ACTIVITIES



An effective CPD policy and system gives staff opportunities to develop and meet their own and the organisation's requirements. It helps create a sense of belonging to the organisation, helps teachers to build professional relationships when sharing and learning from each other, and helps managers identify effective development opportunities to meet the needs of each teacher. CPD takes place across all the stages of a teacher's career. At each stage there are common needs in meeting the challenges of that stage and in going forward. Teachers will also want to achieve their own personal objectives.

Different perspectives on CPD

It is important for managers to be aware of different approaches to CPD, to consider the best ways to engage members of staff and to encourage them to take responsibility for their own professional learning and development. All places of learning are unique and located in their own contexts, which is an important consideration when planning CPD activities. Teachers in the lifelong learning sector have become used to a steady stream of internal and external policy changes, often being required to attend generic, 'packaged' CPD events, and this may result in reluctant compliance and tensions rather than a positive attitude to the training session. On the other hand, CPD can be transformative and personalised, teacher-led and self-differentiated, with teachers forming 'communities of practice'. Therefore, a balance needs to be struck between a balance needs to be struck between achieving the organisation's strategic goals and meeting the needs of individual professional teachers.

TYPES OF CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITY



There are many different types of CPD which can help teachers at each stage of their career, suit their interests and availability of time. In general, the main areas of activity are:

- development of a reflective approach to practice
- expansion and enhancement of pedagogic skills
- updating of knowledge.

These areas are supported through:

- critical reflection on practice
- reading and critical review of resources
- collaboration (sharing and learning) with peers
- participation in further training (for example, workshops, courses).

Some of the information in this section may usefully be included in an 'Induction Manual' for new members of staff.

General resources for CPD

This section contains a selection of resources which provide information and guidance on activities for professional development planning, including support for teacher training.

ESOL Nexus website and CPD Framework:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/teachers>

Guidance on 'professional development planning' can be found at:
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/1159

The *Excellence Gateway* website has many examples of activities and approaches for CPD activities:
<http://tlp.excellencegateway.org.uk/tlp/top/professional-development.html>

CPD Scotland:
www.cpdscotland.org.uk/index.asp

For information on supporting teacher training, there is a 'teacher training kit' available at:
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/1160

The *Learning and Skills Improvement Service* (LSIS) offers a wide range of training events for those working in the Lifelong Learning sector in England, including ESOL teachers. Details can be found at:
www.lsis.org.uk/Pages/default.aspx

Continuing Professional Development in the Lifelong Learning Sector by Peter Scales, Jo Pickering, Lynn Senior, Kath Headley, Patsy Garner and Helen Boulton, published by Open University Press (2010).

Just suppose teaching and learning became the first priority by Frank Coffield, published by Learning and Skills Network, London (2008).

Improving Learning Cultures in Further Education by D James and G Biesta, published by Routledge, London (2007).

Materials for teaching/learning ESOL

This section contains links to some useful websites for materials and resources for teaching ESOL.

The *Excellence Gateway* provides access to many ESOL resources developed as part of the *Skills for Life* strategy such as the Adult ESOL Core Curriculum, ESOL Teaching and Learning materials, Citizenship materials (England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland packs), ESOL materials for Migrant Workers, resources for assessment, etc:
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/1193

ESOL Scotland has a databank of useful resources:
www.esolscotland.com/esol/databanknew.cfm

The Scottish ESOL Curriculum Framework:
www.educationscotland.gov.uk/communitylearninganddevelopment/adultlearning/ESOL/framework/index.asp

UK publishers offer a vast range of resources to support teachers:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/elt-directory/publishers

Trying out or designing teaching materials is a good way of developing that is relevant whatever the level of experience. There are teaching ideas in published books and on websites, such as:

<http://esol.britishcouncil.org>
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/try
www.esolscotland.com/databankresources.cfm
www.esolvideos.co.uk
www.usingenglish.com
www.skillsworkshop.org/esol
www.bbc.co.uk/worldservice/learningenglish
www.talent.ac.uk/dsearch.asp

Magazines and journals

Subscribing to a magazine or journal is a good way to keep up to date with new ideas and themes in ESOL. *NATECLA News* and *Language Issues*, the journal of NATECLA, can be obtained directly from NATECLA:
www.natecla.org.uk/content/483/Language-Issues-The-journal-of-NATECLA

Most magazines and journals are available online as well in hard-copy:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/elt-directory/journals

Reflection

'The teacher's ability to reflect on his or her own practice can be an important driving force to bring about change and improvement. For example, when teachers enter the classroom, they bring with them not just their teaching skills, but also their own experience, perceptions and cultural assumptions of learning.'
 Schellekens, P (2007) *The Oxford ESOL Handbook*.

The ability to reflect on their own practice is an essential skill for all teachers, articulating strengths and weaknesses, and identifying ways to improve.

Articles on developing skills as a reflective practitioner:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/think/articles/reflective-teaching-exploring-our-own-classroom-practice
<http://archive.excellencegateway.org.uk/page.aspx?o=319323>

Mentoring and coaching

Mentoring involves a partnership between a more skilled or experienced person and someone less skilled or experienced. The mutually agreed goal is to help the less skilled person to develop their work-related skills, knowledge and understanding. The relationship is based on the development of skills, confidence and competence and is often referred to as a 'learning conversation'. Mentoring can be a very effective tool for supporting the induction of a new member of staff and is a good developmental activity for an experienced teacher.

Coaching has been defined as 'unlocking a person's potential to maximise their own performance. It is helping them to learn rather than teaching them.'² In peer coaching, two or more colleagues work together to reflect on their practice, share ideas and develop new skills, perhaps conducting action research or problem solving within the workplace, and learning from one another.

There is more about mentoring and coaching on the Excellence Gateway:

Mentoring:
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/17227

A Mentor Guidance document can be downloaded from:
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/17350

An introduction to coaching:
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/12643

Observation

Being observed, observing and getting feedback from a supportive colleague can give a fresh perspective on teaching and help identify areas for development.

Articles on how to make observation work:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/articles/peer-observation
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/think/articles/peer-observation

Guidance on observation:
<http://archive.excellencegateway.org.uk/page.aspx?o=66BDEBFF-4AF9-49BC-8B9C-2CC201458573>

Research

Small-scale classroom action research can be a valuable way to explore teaching and learning processes and so develop professional understanding and skills.

For more information:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/articles/action-research
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/blogs/virdian/classroom-action-research-a-professional-development-process

The National Research and Development Centre for Adult Literacy and Numeracy (NRDC) has published many research reports on ESOL, Literacy and Numeracy in England and Wales:
www.nrdc.org.uk

ESOL Scotland has information and links on ESOL research:
www.esolscotland.com/research.cfm

Networking, groups and associations

A good way for ESOL teachers to develop is to participate in conferences, seminars and workshops, where teachers can meet and talk with colleagues, gain new ideas, reflect on practice, develop their professional judgement and expertise and learn from one another. More experienced and confident teachers can also benefit from giving their own presentations as a way to share experience with other teachers and for their own professional development.

2. Whitmore, J (2003) 3rd Ed. *Coaching for Performance: Growing People, Performance and Purpose*. Nicholas Brearley Publishing: London

Professional associations offer a range of development activities, including conferences, journals, special interest groups, research activities and projects.

Networking with other teachers is one of the most stimulating ways to develop and there are many ESOL/ELT Facebook and Twitter groups for English language teachers.

The UK organisation for all teachers of ESOL is the National Association for Teaching English and Community Languages to Adults (NATECLA) which has a major conference in the UK every year. The association offers networking and training opportunities through its branches, conferences, working groups and online groups, including Facebook and Twitter:
www.natecla.org.uk
<http://twitter.com/#!/NATECLA>

The Northern Association of Teachers of English to Speakers of Other Languages (NATESOL) is based in Manchester and holds six teacher-development sessions a year, including a full day's conference in June:
www.natesol.org

ESOL Scotland has an ESOL Practitioners' Network and ESOL E-News:
www.esolscotland.com/esolnetwork.cfm

Other development opportunities include seminars and courses:
www.esolscotland.com/profdevopps.cfm

The International Association of Teachers of English as a Foreign Language (IATEFL) has an ESOL 'Special Interest Group' (ESOLSIG) and has a major conference in the UK every year:
www.iatefl.org

British Council seminars take place around the UK and are often videoed and made available on the Teaching English website:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/seminars

ESOL-Research is a forum for researchers and practitioners with an interest in research into teaching and learning ESOL. ESOL-Research is managed by Dr James Simpson at the Centre for Language Education Research, School of Education, University of Leeds. To join, visit:
www.jiscmail.ac.uk/lists/ESOL-RESEARCH.html

Institute for Learning (IfL) is the professional body for teachers, trainers, tutors and student teachers in the further education, learning and skills sector in England. It has extensive information on CPD:
www.ifl.ac.uk

The National Institute of Adult Continuing Education, England and Wales (NIACE) offers a wide range of CPD courses and events:
www.niace.org.uk/campaigns-events/events

Trade Unions

Many unions and union branches have branch learning representatives in colleges and learning providers. These representatives can often help people access CPD opportunities both inside and outside the provider. The main teaching unions are:

UCU (University and College Union)
www.ucu.org.uk

ATL (Association of Teachers and Lecturers)
www.atl.org.uk/help-and-advice/performance-management/continuing-professional-development.asp

NASUWT
www.nasuwt.org.uk/MemberSupport/TeacherGroups/FurtherEducationTeacher/index.htm

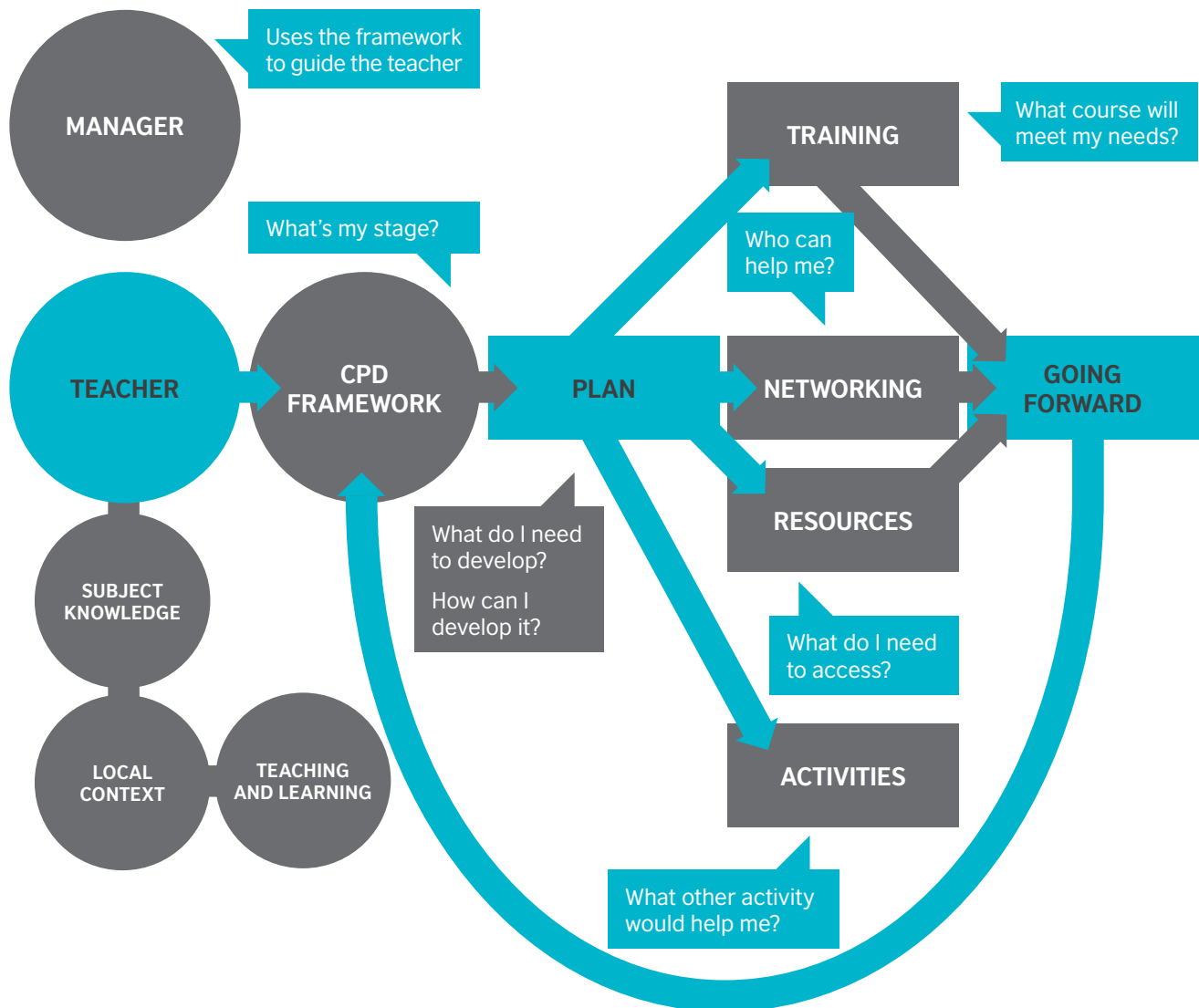
EIS-FELA (Educational Institute of Scotland Further Education Lecturers Association)
www.eis.org.uk/public.asp?id=273&Parentid=1

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

An important part of CPD is having a recognised framework of stages and pathways through which teachers can progress. The British Council framework is presented on the next few pages. It is important to note that although the framework provides suggested pathways for professional development, they are not necessarily sequential and elements from one stage may well overlap with elements from another.

Using the framework is part of a cycle of reflective practice. Teachers can identify the stage they are at, and compare their skills, knowledge and understanding to those represented in the framework. Managers can use the guide for each stage on the following pages to identify their teachers' strengths and areas for development and to find ways of providing opportunities for them to address the diverse challenges they may face in teaching ESOL.

The process can be represented in this way:



THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK

This is our framework of stages of an ESOL teacher's career. It provides a useful way to identify which stages your teachers are at.

Stages			
Novice teachers	1 Starting	Learning the principles of teaching and understanding the ESOL context.	You've just started teaching ESOL and may be on a training course.
	2 Newly qualified	First steps to gaining experience and developing teaching skills.	You have a recognised initial TESOL qualification (or teaching qualification) and are in your first couple of years teaching ESOL.
Teachers with experience	3 Developing	Building teaching skills, knowledge and understanding.	You have a few years' experience and are consolidating your subject knowledge and teaching skills, and deepening your understanding of the potential needs of ESOL learners.
	4 Proficient	Demonstrating consistently good teaching skills, experience and reflection.	You are an experienced ESOL teacher with evidence of further training, and you keep up to date with developments in the field. You may have wider responsibilities, for example, as a curriculum manager.
Teachers progressing into more advanced roles	5 Advanced	Demonstrating excellent teaching skills, knowledge and understanding.	You are a highly-experienced ESOL teacher who may be taking on further responsibilities and a specialist role, for example, as a mentor or external examiner.
	6 Specialist	Leading and advising.	You are a sector expert who advises on policy and practice and you may have a specialist role, for example, as a manager or materials writer.

The following pages provide more detailed information about the different stages of the framework and the areas of development at each stage.

Please refer to the document 'Continuing professional development framework for teachers of ESOL Routes to excellence' and the handbook for teachers for more information about the stages

MANAGING YOUR STAFF AT THE DIFFERENT STAGES OF THEIR DEVELOPMENT

This guide is designed to help you recognise positive indicators of a teacher's development at different stages and explore potential ways of encouraging these further. The guide also identifies common development needs teachers may experience at each stage and provides suggestions to help meet these challenges through supportive approaches and the encouragement of a positive culture towards CPD activity.

For teachers at stage 1 (Indications of development)

Stage 1 – Starting – learning the principles of teaching and understanding the ESOL context	
Indications of development at this stage	Ways of encouraging these
• Wishes to achieve an initial ESOL teaching qualification. • Puts effort into applying learning from training course(s) to own emerging classroom practice. • Keen to develop own knowledge of the English language. • Responds well to feedback on teaching practice. • Keen to observe experienced ESOL teachers. • Enjoys talking to ESOL learners and finding out about their individual needs, skills and circumstances. • Enthusiastic and likes to talk about teaching experiences. • Keeps a reflective log/diary. • Seeks guidance and asks for assistance when unsure. • Receives positive feedback from learners. • Keen to pursue a career in ESOL teaching.	• Provide advice on suitable training courses. • Enable trainees/new teachers to attend training courses and CPD workshops. • Suggest suitable resources, including websites, for developing knowledge of the English language. • Set up a 'Google group' or blog for trainees/new teachers to enable them to share ideas and discuss teaching/learning experiences. • Assign mentors to trainees/new teachers to help them develop their teaching skills and understand learners' needs. • Encourage peer coaching. • Provide opportunities for trainees/new teachers to learn from more experienced colleagues, including peer observations. • Assist trainees/new teachers in developing cultural awareness and increasing their knowledge of the local ESOL context. • Involve trainees/new teachers in department or team meetings and discussions. • Support trainees/new teachers in following organisational procedures and practices. • Ensure that teaching and learning materials are well organised and easily accessible (preferably electronically). • Share positive feedback from learners and colleagues.

For teachers at stage 1 (Indicators of development needs)

Indicators of development needs	Ways of addressing these
• Does not appear interested in gaining qualifications. • Does not take up opportunities to attend courses, training sessions or workshops. • Teaches straight from the book/worksheet and shows no interest in designing or adapting materials/ methods to meet different learner needs. • Struggles with classroom management, basic teaching strategies and techniques. • Receives negative feedback from learners. • Appears to have very little understanding of the needs of the learners or the ESOL context. • General negative signs of professionalism (tardiness, absence, inappropriate dress, inappropriate behaviour). • Views asking for help as a form of weakness. • Does not seem to understand the importance of record-keeping or organisational procedures.	• Explain the importance of gaining a recognised qualification • Cultivate a culture of training by ensuring every member of staff attends at least one training event a year. • Provide opportunities for trainees/new teachers to learn from more experienced colleagues, including observations of experienced teachers. • Assign mentors to trainees/new teachers to help them develop their teaching skills and understand learners' needs. • Offer to observe teaching and provide constructive feedback on specific teaching strategies or techniques. • Develop trainees'/new teachers' awareness of cultural sensitivities and the local context to avoid giving offence. • Encourage reflective practice and the keeping of a diary or log. • Have an open door policy so trainees/new teachers feel they are able to ask questions. • Explain the importance of accurate record-keeping for learners, colleagues and the department/ organisation and assist trainees/new teachers with following organisational procedures.

MANAGING YOUR STAFF AT THE DIFFERENT STAGES OF THEIR DEVELOPMENT

For teachers at stage 2 (Indicators of development)

Stage 2 – Newly qualified – First steps to gaining experience and developing teaching skills	
Indicators of development at this stage	Ways to encourage development
• Attends training courses and actively looks for ways to develop teaching skills and gain qualifications. • Asks for, shares and tries out new ideas. • Achieves positive feedback in observations. • Reflects on teaching and keeps a reflective log/diary. • Views asking for assistance as a positive form of development. • Enthusiastic and likes to talk about what went well. • Seeks guidance and input. • Understands the importance of differentiation and seeks to meet all learners' needs. • General positive signs of professionalism (punctuality, appropriate dress, appropriate behaviour). • Understands the importance of good record-keeping. • Ensures that their role in the department/organisation supports colleagues. • Receives positive feedback from learners. • Many teaching strategies and techniques are becoming 'second nature'.	• Enable teachers to attend training courses and CPD workshops. • Provide opportunities for anything learnt in training to be put into practice. • Have a 'Google group' or blog for new ideas so that sharing becomes part of the culture. • Encourage team teaching and peer coaching. • Have an open door policy so teachers are always welcome to ask questions. • Ensure that records of classes and stores of materials are well organised and easily accessible (preferably electronically). • Encourage and support teachers to differentiate and develop lessons to meet all learners' needs. • Share positive feedback from learners and colleagues. • Encourage thinking about reasons for using specific strategies/techniques as well as the steps involved.

For teachers at stage 2 (Indicators of development needs)

Indicators of development needs	Ways to address these needs
• Does not take up opportunities to attend courses, training sessions or workshops. • Does not appear interested in gaining qualifications. • Teaches straight from the book/worksheet and shows no interest in designing or adapting materials/ methods to meet different learner needs. • Minimal or no planning. • Over-plans by micro-managing classes and does not allow for the 'learner's voice' to be heard. • Appears to have very little understanding of the needs of the learners and teaches according to pre-set judgements. • Views asking for help as a form of weakness. • General negative signs of professionalism (tardiness, absence, inappropriate dress, inappropriate behaviour). • Does not seem to understand the importance of good record-keeping. • Acts independently of others in the department/ organisation and does not actively support their work. • Receives negative feedback from learners. • Struggles with classroom management, basic teaching strategies and techniques.	• Cultivate a culture of training by ensuring every member of staff attends at least one event per year. • Emphasise the importance of gaining a recognised qualification. • Encourage and promote a culture of sharing of teacher-produced materials and resources. • Have an open door policy so teachers are always welcome to ask questions. • Provide opportunities for teacher collaboration and for new teachers to learn from more experienced colleagues, including peer observations. • Assign mentors to new members of staff to help them develop their teaching skills and understand learners' needs. • Promote the sharing of ideas and asking for help and build it into the culture of the organisation. • Develop teachers' awareness of cultural sensitivities and the local context to avoid giving offence. • Explain the importance of accurate record-keeping for learners, colleagues and the department/organisation. • Provide an opportunity to discuss (in confidence) negative feedback from learners and/or colleagues' concerns. • Offer to observe teaching and provide constructive feedback on specific teaching strategies or techniques. • Develop an action plan with the teacher to address concerns. • Encourage reflective practice and the keeping of a diary or log.

MANAGING YOUR STAFF AT THE DIFFERENT STAGES OF THEIR DEVELOPMENT

For teachers at stage 3 (Indicators of development)

Stage 3 – Developing – building teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	
Indicators of development at this stage	Ways to encourage development
• Is enthusiastic and positive about ESOL as a career. • Is keen to attend courses, training sessions and workshops. • Wants to gain further qualifications. • Frequently achieves very good feedback in observations and is keen to be observed. • Is interested in the reasons behind strategies and techniques (theory) as well as the techniques themselves. • Differentiates and adapts teaching strategies to better suit their own teaching style and different learning styles to meet learners' needs. • Is keen to try new approaches. • Shares ideas and resources with colleagues. • Prepares and plans well for lessons. • Fully understands their role in the department/organisation. • Is keen to mentor new colleagues. • Actively contributes to curriculum design and development. • Receives positive feedback from learners. • Keeps a reflective journal/blog. • Copes well with changes to provision as a result of internal or external policy changes.	• Ensure there is a programme of regular, in-house training events. • Enable teachers to attend courses, conferences and workshops. • Provide opportunities for teachers to undertake further recognised teaching qualifications. • Have an open door policy so teachers are always welcome to ask questions. • Encourage thinking about reasons for different teaching approaches, strategies and techniques. • Encourage the sharing of new ideas and resources through online blogs or groups. • Encourage peer coaching and team-teaching. • Involve teachers in course reviews and the organisation's self-assessment reports. • Encourage a buddying/mentoring system. • Allow teachers to expand and develop their role whilst providing support and encouragement. • Offer an opportunity for additional responsibility, for example, an aspect of curriculum development. • Encourage discussion and support teachers in adapting to changes resulting from the introduction of new policies.

For teachers at stage 3 (Indicators of development needs)

Indicators of development needs	Ways to address these needs
• Has 'it's just a job' mentality – looks for the easiest options. • Minimal or no preparation – grabs some worksheets and walks in. • Has reached a plateau – stuck in their ways – 'Has seen it all before'. • Cannot teach 'outside the box', i.e. wedded to books/worksheets. • Does not differentiate to meet learners' needs or take account of different learning styles. • Dislikes criticism and avoids situations that generate criticism. • Is 'technically' good but shows little understanding of the importance of the 'learner's voice'. • Acts independently of others in department/ organisation and does not keep accurate/ up-to-date records. • Receives negative feedback from learners. • Tends to grumble about problems in department/ organisation but offers no solution. • Does not cope well with change. • Appears to be struggling with workload (for example, misses deadlines, may be showing signs of stress or emotional instability).	• Cultivate a culture of training by expecting every member of staff to attend at least one event per year and encourage them to attend a workshop that interests them. • Have an open door policy and encourage teachers to ask for support when necessary. • Encourage peer observation and team-teaching to reinvigorate teaching. • Offer support with integrating differentiation strategies into teaching and learning. • Discuss strategies to develop their role and re-motivate them. • Explain how their role and their record-keeping affect everyone working in the department/ organisation. • Discuss in confidence negative feedback from learners. • Assure teachers that their comments will be taken into account in course reviews and self-assessment reports. • Encourage reflective practice and the keeping of a diary or log. • Develop an action plan to work on areas of concern. • Offer individual support and guidance if possible.

Note: some of these 'Indicators of development needs' may continue to be areas of concern at Stages 4 and 5.

MANAGING YOUR STAFF AT THE DIFFERENT STAGES OF THEIR DEVELOPMENT

For teachers at stage 4 (Indicators of development)

Stage 4 – Proficient – demonstrating consistently good teaching skills, experience and reflection	
Indicators of development at this stage	Ways to encourage development
• Is an enthusiastic and motivating teacher, able to differentiate to meet all learners' needs. • Regularly achieves very positive feedback in observations. • Is keen to gain new knowledge and skills through further specialist training and to use this to improve department/organisation. • Wants more variety and seeks new challenges. • Is keen to improve quality of teaching and learning through innovative practice. • Reads reports and journal articles and keeps up to date with developments in the field. • Is an active member of a professional association. • Wants to get involved in new projects and undertake action research. • Is a reflective practitioner. • Works well in a team and is keen to mentor others. • Is motivated by teaching others. • Receives excellent feedback from learners. • Can bring constructive and sensitive feedback to peer observation. • Responds well to curriculum changes resulting from new internal or external policies.	• Recognise achievements at team meetings and in department/organisation newsletters. • Provide variety and challenge – offer different levels and class types and allow space for innovation and experimentation. • Offer opportunities to gain further, specialist qualifications and to attend specific training sessions, conferences and events. • Discuss and provide opportunities for action research. • Welcome and review ideas for curriculum design and development. • Offer additional responsibilities, such as curriculum development or mentoring. • Offer opportunities to work on new projects. • Encourage them to deliver training sessions to peers and/or give a presentation at a conference. • Encourage open reflection for others to learn from. • Encourage them to contribute to course reviews and the organisation's self-assessment reports. • Encourage networking with other ESOL practitioners. • Support them in developing skills transfers from one area to another. • Involve them in implementing curriculum changes.

For teachers at Stage 5 (Indicators of development)

Stage 5 – Advanced – demonstrating excellent teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	
Indicators of development at this stage	Ways to encourage development
• Is enthusiastic and positive about their work. • Usually achieves very positive feedback in observations. • Shows enthusiasm for taking on new responsibilities, such as leading a project development. • Enjoys the challenges of new responsibilities and will ask for help if necessary. • Can see how new areas of responsibility positively influence teaching and learning, for example mentoring improves understanding of class needs. • Wants to support other teachers in successfully completing their training courses. • Remembers issues from teaching career and uses experience to help other teachers. • Supports colleagues with inclusion and differentiation strategies. • Is keen to develop new knowledge and skills by undertaking action research. • Recognises that there is always space for development. • Is supportive of curriculum changes resulting from the introduction of new policies.	• Ensure achievements are recognised by others in the organisation/department publicly. • Keep up excitement and passion by providing new challenges and career opportunities. • Offer the opportunity to gain an advanced specialist qualification. • Continue to offer opportunities to attend specialist training workshops, conferences and events. • Encourage skills transfers from one area to another. • Encourage sharing of ideas and resources with other teachers. • Offer opportunities to lead a project or carry out some classroom research. • Support them in publishing their research in a journal. • Encourage them to write an article for an ESOL blog, newsletter or peer-reviewed journal. • Discuss their career goals and facilitate their career development where possible. • Encourage reflective practice and discussion so that teachers can learn from one another's experience. • Encourage them to lead on the implementation of changes resulting from the introduction of new policies.

MANAGING YOUR OWN CPD AS AN ESOL MANAGER AT STAGE 6

Stage 6	Specialist – Leading and advising
At this stage you will have these characteristics	• You work as an ESOL manager and may also be involved in teacher-training, project management, research, assessing or examining. • You may be in charge of a number of staff, may work in an FE college, a sixth form college, a work-based learning provider, an Adult and Community Centre, a voluntary organisation, offender learning or in higher education. • You may be a sector expert who advises on policy and practice.
You may have some of these needs and goals	• To create an ethos and culture which values and encourages professional development. • To introduce curriculum changes to improve the provision. • To develop better systems and better programmes of learning. • To influence change in the organisation. • To manage targets set by your managers. • To develop your skills in a new area, for example, project management. • To conduct advanced study and research in a specialist area. • To publish articles and reports. • To reduce the amount of time spent on administration. • To extend your networks to find other specialists you can work with. • To manage a larger department or organisation. • To maintain pedagogical skills, contact with learners and the teaching environment.
How you progress at this stage	• Use of reflective practice will help you develop your current role. • Identifying and undertaking relevant management skills training. • Learning more about specialist roles helps you to gain experience in new areas. • Improving systems and lines of communication allows for greater efficiency. • Coaching and mentoring members of your team. • Being coached/mentored by other managers. • Making contacts helps you to find avenues into new areas.
Priority focus at this stage	• Maximise your time to achieve the results you want for yourself and your staff and allow for new projects and new directions.
Going forward	• Take a longer-term view and identify your own aims and goals: What do you need to do now in order to get to where you want to be? What do you need to do for your department/staff to get where you want them to be?



For teachers at Stage 6 (Indicators of development)

Stage 6 – Specialist – Leading and advising	
Indicators of development at this stage	Ways to develop further
• You recognise that there are stages of development within this stage – for example, you may be new to management. • You espouse a philosophy of CPD and have a reflective approach to your work. • You believe in sharing both knowledge and experience. • You are creative and thirsty for new ideas. • You bring other people forward when you move forward. • You seek the opinions of others and increase your personal learning network. • You understand how to influence change in the organisation.	• Appraisals are an important way of exploring strengths and weaknesses. • Take up opportunities to attend specialist training courses and seminars. • Reflective practice becomes most effective when it is possible to see the direct benefit of reflecting on work done. • Create a culture of people sharing ideas to bring the department/organisation forward. • Create a culture which rewards risk if that risk increases the learning of the department/organisation. • Wherever possible, seek opinions of stakeholders and others from both inside and outside the department/organisation.

DEVELOPING A CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (CPD) POLICY FOR YOUR DEPARTMENT OR ORGANISATION

These notes are intended to provide guidance for managers in developing a CPD policy for their department or organisation. The guidance draws on effective practice in CPD in the lifelong learning sector in the UK. However, a successful policy needs to be tailored to the character and needs of the particular organisation and reflect the results of consultation and reflection with staff.

What are the benefits of a clear CPD policy?

- It enables planning and progress towards organisational and individual improvement to take place.
- It enables staff to identify and develop the skills, knowledge and attributes they need to progress and to take responsibility for their own professional development.
- It enables the organisation to respond better to stakeholders and to increase their satisfaction with the service provided.
- It motivates staff to be lifelong learners and to refresh their professional practice.
- It contributes to the wider reputation and credibility of the organisation.
- It provides pathways for career progression and increases staff satisfaction.

How do you develop an effective CPD policy?

You need to develop a clear vision of effective and improving practice, shared by all staff involved, and based on evidence for effective teaching and learning. This may begin with a full training needs analysis and should take account of:

The needs of the organisation:

- What are the aims and ambitions of the organisation?
- What areas of improvement have been identified to meet these aims and ambitions better?

The professional needs, interests, previous experience and aims of individual staff:

- What goals do staff members set themselves?
- What improvements do managers want to see?

The resources for CPD available to the centre:

- What provision is available within the organisation, locally, online and more widely?
- What investment is available to support it?
- What accreditation of CPD is available for staff?

An effective policy will also need to evaluate the impact of CPD on teaching and learning and in achieving goals/targets for the organisation and the individual member of staff. This information needs to be fed back to inform the planning of future CPD activity.

An appraisal system can support CPD by providing a formal opportunity to discuss strengths and areas for development.



Planning CPD

CPD activity should be part of a quality assurance process that connects:

- CPD and ongoing development
- performance management
- inspection framework
- development planning

A CPD policy document should provide information on the organisation's approach to CPD and provide staff with resources and tools to plan and record their CPD activities.

Where an organisation employs staff on short-term or temporary contracts, the CPD policy should include provision for them to access CPD during their employment. This will enable them to be integrated into the professional ethos of the organisation, meet expected standards, find support to deal effectively with the challenges of teaching, and understand how the work contributes to their own career and professional development.

Measuring the impact of the CPD policy:

Measurement is essential to validate and improve the CPD process. The measures required will depend on the specific nature of the CPD policy and activity undertaken as part of that policy.

Measurement can take place:

- as part of the performance appraisal process
- through evaluation of learner satisfaction and achievement
- through staff self-evaluation
- from qualitative and quantitative data gathered from observation, questionnaires, research, and exam and test results
- from inspection reports.

Useful resources

A 'Professional Development Planning Provider Kit' is available to support organisations delivering ESOL, Literacy or Numeracy in planning professional development for their staff
www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/1159

The British Council's Continuing Professional Development ESOL NEXUS Portal

For further support go to the ESOL NEXUS CPD portal, which has a section for managers and teachers.
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/teacher-development>

NOTES

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